

Of Vista And DPI

With the advent of laptops, the screen resolution has gone up, and the screen sizes down. This has led to screens with a very high pixel density (DPI)—as much as 144 DPI as compared to the comfortable 96 DPI of a typical desktop computer. As DPI rises, the size of fonts decreases. Now Vista, ought to, in theory at least, be able to solve this problem through its use of vector graphics. Unfortunately, due to hardware limitations, the interface of Vista itself is not vectorised and thus not resolution-independent. Vista however, does offer a better DPI scaling solution than Windows XP; it even offers high-resolution icons to go along with high-DPI displays. As you can see in the images below, the DPI scaling is not perfect: everything is nice until the 144DPI mark, after which the interface loses cohesion.



After the 144DPI mark, power buttons in the Start menu get out of proportion, while the search icon in Windows Explorer gets out-of-place. The Sidebar gadgets do not scale at all



To increase the DPI setting in Vista right-click on your desktop and click on Personalize. On the left-hand pane click on the “Adjust font size (DPI)” option